

# Post-incident review PIR-2025-033

## Mobile Backend: partial outage

*Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.*

### Summary

On 05 March 2025, Mobile Backend experienced partial outage in staging (AU Southeast) for about 55 minutes. A partner raised a case with the service desk before any internal signal fired. Investigation found that a retry loop without backoff multiplied the load on a struggling downstream call.

### Impact

Users of Mobile Backend saw partial outage for about 55 minutes. The service owner, Mobile Engineering, led the response.

### Timeline

- 09:11 First signal received.
- 09:28 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:50 Likely cause identified.
- 10:00 Mitigation applied.
- 10:52 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

### What happened

Investigation found that a retry loop without backoff multiplied the load on a struggling downstream call.

The expected load had not been tested before release.

All traffic depended on one component with no standby.

### What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

### Actions

- Exercise the rollback path in staging as part of every release.
- Add a pre-deployment check that validates the setting against the production baseline.
- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.